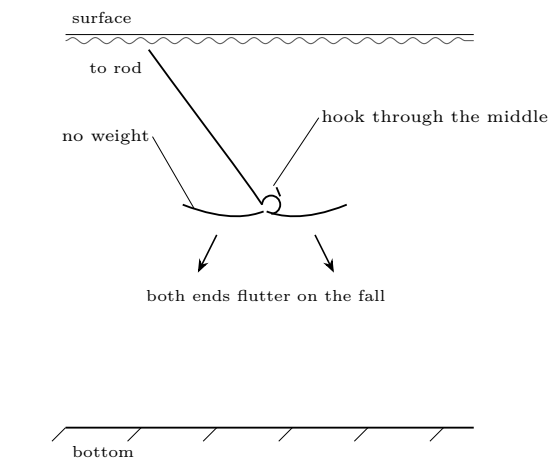




What it does	A straight soft-plastic worm hooked through its middle, with no weight at all. On the fall both halves shimmy independently. Nothing else in fishing moves like it.
Why it works	It falls slowly, horizontally, and looks alive while doing nothing. In water as clear as Pine Lake’s, a slow horizontal fall beats an active retrieve.
Components	One 1/0 or 2/0 octopus or wide-gap hook, one 5 in stick worm. That is the entire rig.
O-ring	Slide a small rubber O-ring onto the worm’s middle and hook under the ring instead of through the plastic. One worm then lasts twenty fish instead of two.
Line	6–10lb. Spinning tackle. Fluorocarbon leader on Pine Lake.
Catches	Largemouth above all; smallmouth and big bluegill will take it too.

Fish it

1. Cast past the target — a dock, a weed clump, an edge — and **do nothing**.
2. Watch the line. The worm is falling on a slack line and almost every bite happens here. If the line twitches, jumps, or stops falling, reel down and sweep.
3. If it reaches the bottom untouched, give the rod two small shakes, then let it sit for a slow count of five.
4. Lift, let it fall again, and repeat. Retrieve slowly and cast again.

Getting it right

Patience	The single most common mistake is fishing it too fast. This rig catches fish while it is doing nothing. If you feel like you are wasting time, you are probably fishing it correctly.
Watch the line	You will not feel most bites. You will see them. Keep a slight bow in the line and keep your eyes on where it enters the water.
Wind	The one condition it hates. In a chop you cannot see the line; switch to a <i>see the Texas rig sheet</i> or a jig.
Where	Pine spots 5 , 6 and 7 — especially in bright, calm, high-sun conditions when nothing else produces. North spots 1 and 7 .
Hookset	A firm sweep, not a snap. The hook is exposed; it does not need to be driven through plastic.

When to use it
Bright sun, flat calm, clear water, pressured fish — exactly the conditions where everyone else stops catching. On Pine Lake in July this is the highest-percentage bass presentation on the sheet, and it takes ten seconds to tie.

Telos. Lake Country Fishing — Wacky Rig. Revised 2026-07-25. Project-created text and diagrams are licensed CC BY 4.0. Incorporated public-domain artwork remains public domain and is credited on the plate it appears with. See LICENSE and CREDITS.md in the source. Nothing here is professional advice; verify current regulations and follow the stated safety procedure.